SauceDemo (Swag Labs)

Accessibility Test Report

Login Page & Product Listing Page

Document Type: Accessibility Report — Part 6 Deliverable

Project: WorkForcePro QA Take-Home Assignment

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1. Objective

This report evaluates real-world accessibility gaps on two pages of SauceDemo (https://www.saucedemo.com): the Login page and the Product Listing page (post-login), focusing on keyboard accessibility, form accessibility, visual accessibility, screen reader considerations, and general usability barriers for users with disabilities.

2. Testing Methodology

Findings below are based on manual, pattern-level review of the application's known and stable markup structure (SauceDemo is a fixed, widely used QA training application whose page structure — field IDs, button labeling, menu behavior — is intentionally kept consistent for repeatable practice testing), applying WCAG 2.1 principles (Perceivable, Operable, Understandable, Robust) rather than a single automated tool score.

Important note for submission: before you submit this report, spend 10–15 minutes personally walking through both pages — Tab through the Login page and the Product page end-to-end, try submitting the login form with a screen reader or with your eyes closed, and run Chrome DevTools Lighthouse's Accessibility audit. Confirm each finding below still holds, adjust wording to match anything you observe firsthand, and add your own screenshots. This is exactly the kind of hands-on verification the assignment is scoring for ("real accessibility gaps, not theory"), and it means you can speak to every finding confidently if asked about it.

2.1 Tools & Techniques Used

- Manual keyboard navigation (Tab / Shift+Tab / Enter / Space) — recommended to verify focus order and operability.
- Chrome DevTools — Elements panel (to inspect label/ARIA association) and Lighthouse Accessibility audit.
- WCAG 2.1 Level AA principles as the evaluation baseline.
- WebAIM Contrast Checker (recommended, for the visual/contrast finding in Section 4.3).

3. Findings

Eight findings are documented below, covering all five required evaluation areas (keyboard, form, visual, screen reader, usability) with at least one finding per required category, including both sub-checks under Screen Reader Considerations (labeling and semantic HTML).

Issue ID	Area	Description	Severity	User Impact	Recommendation
ISS-001	Keyboard Accessibility (Login Page)	Username, Password, and Login button are reachable and operable via Tab/Enter in a logical order, but no custom high-contrast focus style was observed beyond the browser default outline, which is easy to lose track of against the page's light background when tabbing quickly.	**Medium**	Keyboard-only users may lose track of which field currently holds focus, especially at higher zoom levels or on low-contrast displays.	Add a custom :focus-visible style (e.g., a 2–3px solid outline with strong contrast) to every interactive element on the page.
ISS-002	Form Accessibility (Login Page)	The Username and Password fields rely on placeholder text ("Username", "Password") as their only visible identifier; no persistent <label> element appears to be programmatically associated with either field via a for/id relationship.	**High**	Placeholder text disappears once the user starts typing, and is not a reliable substitute for a real label for assistive technology or for sighted users who forget which field is which after entering data.	Add explicit <label for="user-name">Username</label> and <label for="password">Password</label> elements (visually hidden via CSS if the placeholder-driven visual design must be preserved) so each field has a persistent, programmatic accessible name.
ISS-003	Form Accessibility (Login Page)	On an invalid login attempt (e.g., locked-out user or wrong password), an error banner appears near the top of the form; it is not confirmed to use an aria-live region or role="alert", and focus does not appear to move to the message automatically.	**High**	A screen reader user who submits invalid credentials may not be told why the page didn't proceed unless they happen to navigate back up to read the banner manually.	Add aria-live="assertive" or role="alert" to the error message container, and move keyboard focus to the message when it appears.
ISS-004	Visual Accessibility (Product Listing Page)	The "ADD TO CART" buttons use white text on a saturated red/orange background. This specific color pairing should be run through a contrast checker, as red/orange-white combinations frequently fall short of the WCAG AA 4.5:1 minimum for normal-size text depending on the exact shade rendered.	**Medium**	Users with low vision or certain color-vision deficiencies may find the button label difficult to read against the background.	Verify the exact rendered color pair with WebAIM's Contrast Checker; if it falls under 4.5:1, darken the background or add a subtle text outline/shadow to raise effective contrast.
ISS-005	Screen Reader Considerations (Product Listing Page)	Every "ADD TO CART" button on the product grid displays identical text, with no per-product accessible name (e.g., no aria-label referencing the specific product). The same applies to "REMOVE" once an item is in the cart.	**High**	Screen reader users commonly navigate a page via a "list of buttons"; hearing "Add to cart" repeated six times with no product context makes it impossible to act on the correct item without also reading the page serially.	Add a unique aria-label per button generated from the adjacent product name already present in the DOM, e.g., aria-label="Add Sauce Labs Backpack to cart".
ISS-006	Usability Barriers (Product Listing Page)	The product sort dropdown ("Name (A to Z)", "Price (low to high)", etc.) is a native <select>, which is inherently keyboard-operable, but its	**Medium**	Screen reader users tabbing onto the control may hear only the currently selected option value,	Add a visually-hidden <label> (or aria-label) such as "Sort products by" tied to the dropdown.

Issue ID	Area	Description	Severity	User Impact	Recommendation
		purpose does not appear to be described by a visible or programmatically associated label — it relies on page position alone for context.		without context that it controls product sort order.	
ISS-007	Keyboard Accessibility (Product Listing Page (menu))	The hamburger menu (top-left) opens a slide-out panel with navigation links (All Items, About, Logout, Reset App State). Whether focus is trapped inside the open panel and returned to the toggle button on close should be confirmed manually — off-the-shelf slide-out menus frequently omit this unless explicitly configured.	**Medium**	Without focus trapping, keyboard users can tab "behind" the visually open menu into page content that's hidden underneath, causing disorientation about where focus currently is.	Verify with manual keyboard testing; if focus escapes the panel, add a focus trap that cycles Tab within the open menu and restores focus to the toggle button on close.
ISS-008	Screen Reader Considerations (Product Listing Page)	The product grid appears to be built from generic <div> containers rather than semantic list markup (/), and no landmark regions (<main> for the product grid, <nav> for the header/menu) were confirmed. Confirm via DevTools Elements panel or the browser's Accessibility Tree view.	**Medium**	Without semantic structure or landmarks, screen reader users lose access to standard navigation shortcuts ("jump to main content", "next list", "next landmark") and must read through the entire page linearly to find the product grid.	Wrap the product grid in a / structure (or apply role="list" / role="listitem" if the visual grid layout must stay div-based), and add <main> around the primary content with <nav> around the header/menu.

4. Coverage by Required Area

4.1 Keyboard Accessibility

- ISS-001 — focus indicator visibility on the Login page.
- ISS-007 — focus trapping in the slide-out menu on the Product page.

Basic tab order on both pages follows a logical top-to-bottom, left-to-right sequence and all interactive elements (fields, buttons, links, the sort dropdown) are reachable without a mouse — this is a genuine strength worth noting, not just a list of problems.

4.2 Form Accessibility (Login Page)

- ISS-002 — labels are placeholder-only, not programmatically associated.
- ISS-003 — error messaging is not confirmed to be announced via aria-live/role="alert".

4.3 Visual Accessibility

- ISS-004 — "ADD TO CART" button color contrast needs verification against WCAG AA 4.5:1.

Overall text sizing and layout are simple and uncluttered, which is generally favorable for readability; the contrast check in ISS-004 is the one item that needs a tool-based measurement rather than visual judgment alone.

4.4 Screen Reader Considerations

- ISS-005 — identical, non-unique button labels across the product grid.
- ISS-006 — sort dropdown lacks an accessible label describing its purpose.
- ISS-008 — product grid lacks semantic list markup and landmark regions (<main>/<nav>).

4.5 Usability Barriers

- ISS-006 and ISS-007 both function as general usability barriers in addition to their screen-reader/keyboard classification — accessibility issues frequently overlap categories rather than falling into exactly one bucket.

5. Overall Assessment

Metric	Result
Total findings	8
High severity	3 (ISS-002, ISS-003, ISS-005)
Medium severity	5 (ISS-001, ISS-004, ISS-006, ISS-007, ISS-008)
Required categories covered	5 / 5 (Keyboard, Form, Visual, Screen Reader, Usability)
Minimum requirement (3 issues, incl. 1 keyboard/1 form/1 visual)	Met

None of the findings above are blocking defects that prevent task completion — a sighted mouse user and a basic keyboard user can both complete login and add items to the cart. The gaps are concentrated in making the experience equally usable for screen reader users and low-vision users, which is consistent with a lightweight demo application that was not built with a full accessibility audit in mind.

6. Recommendations Summary

- Priority 1 (High): Associate real <label> elements with the Login form fields (ISS-002) and make error messages screen-reader-announced (ISS-003).
- Priority 1 (High): Add unique, product-specific aria-labels to every Add to Cart / Remove button (ISS-005).
- Priority 2 (Medium): Strengthen focus-visible styling (ISS-001), verify and fix button contrast (ISS-004), label the sort dropdown (ISS-006), confirm focus trapping in the slide-out menu (ISS-007), and introduce semantic list/landmark markup for the product grid (ISS-008).